Anthony Mavunde

(mah-SAH-noo)

Minister of Minerals
United Republic of Tanzania

Addressed as: **Honorable Minister** | Office held since: **June 2023**

Anthony Mavunde is an up-and-coming politician who brings his boundless energy, legal expertise, and technological vision to Tanzania's minerals portfolio.

- **Minister of Reform**
  Mavunde is eager to modernize and streamline the mining sector, arguing for transparency, accountability, and new technologies–including drones for mineral exploration and digital systems for management–are key to better outcomes.

- **Servant of the People**
  Mavunde carefully curates an image of service, including by calling himself a “servant of the people” in his social media profile. He prioritizes connecting with his audiences and relevant stakeholders.

Mavunde is part of a small cohort of senior government officials in their forties. His retention as Minerals Minister following the October 2025 election—one of only 11 ministers kept in the same portfolio—signals President Samia's confidence in his performance.

WHY THEY MATTER

Mavunde is committed to proving that "Tanzania is safe for investment," while ensuring that mining delivers tangible benefits to Tanzanians through value addition, local content, and youth empowerment.

- **Delivering Results**
  Under Mavunde's tenure, Tanzania's mining sector reached a milestone: revenue hit 1 trillion shillings by June 2025. He has championed major projects including the $523 million Nyanzaga gold mine—the largest gold development in Tanzania in over 17 years.

- **Cleaning House**
  Mavunde has taken an aggressive stance against dormant licenses, revoking 73 exploration and medium-scale mining permits in November 2025 after holders failed to develop their concessions.

The Minister wants to deliver real benefits to fellow Tanzanians through his work in the mining sector. He has remarked that "our vision isn't simply to dig up minerals, it's to ignite the engines of prosperity."

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MEETING WITH THEM

Mavunde is a proactive and decisive leader who uses humility, humor, and his personal engagement to achieve his goals.

- **Hands-On Approach**
  Mavunde is often well-prepared and on top of his brief, and he is quick to address challenges firsthand. When concerns are raised by stakeholders, he will visit the mining site to understand the issue.

- **Rapport-Building**
  The Minister brings a personal touch to his relationships, disarming his interlocutors with his authenticity and honesty. While he can be surprisingly direct about sensitive issues, he cushions it with diplomatic language to remain on good terms.

While formal in his speeches and presentations, his social media posts reveal a more playful side: singing at events, backslapping colleagues, and liberally using emojis to show his gratitude.

ON THEIR MIND

- **Tanzanian Buys East Africa's biggest Media Outlet**
  Tanzanian business magnate Rostam Azizi in mid-March bought the majority share of Nairobi-based Nation Media Group, East Africa's largest media house. Azizi was named Tanzania's first dollar billionaire by Forbes magazine in 2013.

- **Tanzania Ranks Fourth for Mining Investments in Africa**
  The Fraser Institute in early March revealed that Tanzania has significantly improved its global standing as a destination for international mining, placing 34th over all and 4th in Africa.

- **Moody's Afffirms Tanzania's Rating**
  Moody's Ratings in February affirmed Tanzania's B1 local currency and foreign currency long-term issuer ratings today and maintained a stable outlook. The rating reflects the country's weak institutional framework and low incomes balanced against strong growth momentum and resilience to shocks

- **U.S.-Tanzanian Relations**
  Following President Samia's marred election, the United States in December 2025 announced it was reviewing its ties with Tanzania, citing concerns over investment, governance, and restrictions on religious freedom and free speech.

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NETWORK

While Mavunde is building close ties with U.S. government officials and business firms, he also has engaged other countries, including Belarus, China, Italy, Russia, and the United Kingdom.

Mavunde has highlighted the potential of the Kabanga Nickel Project as a model for U.S.-Tanzania economic cooperation. Though he is positive about China's role in producing graphite, he has shown a willingness to restrict Chinese mining operations when conflicts arise with local, small-scale miners.

Mavunde has built a strong network within the CCM, earning President Samia's trust as evidenced by his retention in the November 2025 cabinet reshuffle. His role in the CCM youth movement has likely aided his ascension in the party's ranks.

Mavunde seems keenly aware of the challenges of navigating the internal cliques within ruling Chama Cha Mapinduzi (CCM), thriving under President Samia and past presidents Magufuli and Kikwete. As he leverages his accomplishments to fuel his political rise, he takes care to praise party leadership and avoid missteps.

CONTROVERSIES

Mavunde has largely avoided major controversies, though his enforcement actions and rapid rise have drawn some scrutiny.

- **License Crackdown**
  His November 2025 revocation of 73 mining licenses has generated pushback from operators who claim the enforcement is heavy-handed. The ministry issued 205 default notices, including some companies holding licenses since 2013 without commencing operations.

- **Yanga Loyalties**
  Mavunde's passion for Young Africans Sports Club (Yanga) has earned him some detractors. He has faced scrutiny regarding his commitment to his ministerial duties versus his involvement in Yanga, prompting then-president Magufuli to question whether he was spending too much time on the football club.

His relative youth has occasionally prompted questions about experience, though his technical competence and consistent delivery have generally quieted critics.

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CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Minister of Minerals**, United Republic of Tanzania (2023 to present)
- **Deputy Minister of Agriculture**, United Republic of Tanzania (2022 to 2023)
- **Deputy Minister for Labour, Employment, and Youth**, United Republic of Tanzania (2015 to 2020)
- **Member of Parliament**, Dodoma Urban Constituency (2015 to present)
- **Chief Executive Officer,** The Federation of Miners' Associations of Tanzania (2013 to 2015)
- **Managing Partner**, RGK Law Chambers Advocates (201o to 2015)
- **CCM Young Wing Roles**, Chama Cha Mapinduzi (2006 to 2017)

BIO

Mavunde's background as a lawyer and his upbringing in Dodoma have shaped his professional and personal outlook. Born on March 2, 1984, Mavunde seems to favor fashionable suits and stylish casual wear to highlight his professional accomplishments and youthful vigor.

- **Lawyerly Background**
  Mavunde holds a Bachelor of Laws from Mzumbe University and Master's in International Relations from University of Dodoma. He honed his expertise in legal practice and business management as a partner at RGK Law Chambers Advocates.

- **Sports Aficionado**
  Mavunda is passionate about the Yanga football team where his leadership role and efforts to revive the club financially prompted one sports historian to say "Yanga is more than a club—it's a family." Mavunda is also involved in the Tanzania Basketball Federation (TBF) and has visited a local karate dojo.

Mavunde is married with at least two children. Similar to many Tanzanian politicians, he frequents churches and mosques to pray with congregations. While he speaks fluent English and Swahili, he conducts most of his public appearances and social media posts in Swahili.

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